

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Consolidation before durable expansion

1555 RESTORATION -> Mughal foothold, not a settled empire

1556 CRISIS -> Hemu, Sikandar Sur, Afghan strength and Kabul uncertainty

REGENCY -> Bairam Khan stabilises command during Akbar's minority

PERSONAL RULE -> household and noble alternatives are disciplined

EXPANSION -> campaigns are joined to alliances, ranks, jagirs and retention

VERDICT: durability came from reconquest + elite integration + institutions.

MUST REMEMBER: After Panipat II (1556), Akbar consolidated through campaigns, diplomacy, elite incorporation and negotiated alliances.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Akbar chronology 1542-1605

1542 Amarkot -> 1556 Kalanaur and Second Panipat
1556-60 -> Bairam Khan regency | 1562 -> Adham Khan crisis
1567 -> Uzbek challenge broken | 1568 -> Chittor
1572-73 -> Gujarat conquest and rapid return
1576 -> Daud Khan defeated; Haldighati
1580-81 -> eastern rebellion and Mirza Hakim | 1605 -> Akbar dies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: The fractured field of 1556

AKBAR / BAIRAM -> fragile restored centre and young sovereign

HEMU -> Adil Shah's commander with Afghan army, elephants and artillery

SIKANDAR SUR -> continuing Afghan territorial alternative

KABUL / MIRZA FIELD -> north-western dynastic and communications risk

PANIPAT II -> Hemu's wound disrupts command; Mughal victory remains contingent

TRAP: the battle reopens consolidation; it does not end every rival at once.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Bairam Khan to personal rule

1556-60 REGENCY -> wakil mutlaq rallies nobles and secures the regime
TENSION -> delegated power, court factions and Akbar's growing autonomy
DISMISSAL -> Bairam resists, submits, is pardoned and leaves for pilgrimage
HOUSEHOLD FIELD -> Maham Anaga, Adham Khan and access to the young ruler
ATKA KHAN MURDER -> Adham's execution re-centres sovereign authority
LESSON: regency enabled survival but could not become permanent kingship.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Noble and Uzbek challenge

OLD NOBLES -> commands and jagirs create bases for bargaining

UZBEK REBELLION -> Khan-i-Zaman and allies resist centralising control

AKBAR -> manoeuvre, pardon, transfer and force divide the opposition

JUNE 1567 -> Khan-i-Zaman defeated; major internal alternative broken

EFFECT -> mobilisation and reward become more credible for distant campaigns

QUALIFY: central security enabled expansion but did not abolish faction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Malwa and Garh-Katanga: coercive limits

MALWA -> Baz Bahadur defeated; Adham corrected; Baz later enters Mughal service

GARH-KATANGA -> Rani Durgavati resists; conquest brings death and plunder

IMPERIAL VIEW -> expansion and agent discipline | REGIONAL VIEW -> agency and resources

TRAP: integration joined selective accommodation to severe coercion.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Rajput policy in phases

EARLY ALLIES -> Amber before Chittor; service through mansabs, office and watan

GUJARAT PHASE -> Rajputs become an imperial arm; after 1578 partnership deepens

SURJAN HADA -> service without marriage disproves a marriage-only explanation

LIMIT -> honour and patronage sustained an unequal political alliance.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Chittor, Ranthambhor and the Mewar exception

RAJASTHAN -> flank security and routes toward Malwa and Gujarat

CHITTOR -> strategic fort, symbolic resistance and massacre | RANTHAMBHOR -> settlement

MOST RAJAS -> honour, office and local status | MEWAR -> submission remains unresolved

RULE: force backed settlement; settlement did not erase refusal or violence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Gujarat and Bengal: conquest plus retention

GUJARAT -> ports and maritime access; 1572-73 conquest followed by rapid return

HUMAYUN CONTRAST -> local command and retention are treated more deliberately

BIHAR-BENGAL -> Afghan resistance and river logistics; Daud Khan defeated in 1576

LIMIT -> Bengal needs continuing attention; conquest is not instant pacification.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Haldighati: coalition and outcome

MUGHAL -> Man Singh's mixed force | MEWAR -> Rajputs, Bhils and Hakim Khan's Afghans

BATTLE 1576 -> political struggle over submission and regional autonomy

OUTCOME -> tactical Mughal advantage; Rana Pratap continues resistance and recovery

TRAP: mixed coalitions defeat a Hindu-versus-Muslim framing.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Rajput policy was differentiated across houses and moments; alliance, service, resistance and coercion coexisted.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Rebellion, frontier and source method

1580-81 REBELLION + MIRZA HAKIM -> fiscal, noble, Kabul and Punjab pressures

AKBAR -> mobility, loyal commanders and a broader elite contain the crisis

ABUL FAZL -> imperial narrative | BADAUNI / BARDIC MEMORY -> dissent and honour limits

FATEHPUR SIKRI -> material imperial centre, not proof of every policy outcome.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Expansion maps indicate changing claims and fronts, not uniform administration over every shaded territory.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 15 answer spine

OPEN -> Akbar inherited a restored but fractured political field

RECONQUEST -> Panipat II + continuing Afghan and frontier containment

CENTRE -> regency transition + household discipline + Uzbek defeat

EXPANSION -> Malwa, Rajasthan, Gujarat and Bengal with varied mechanisms

INTEGRATION -> Rajput alliance and composite service widen the loyalty base

CLOSE -> durable empire joined coercion, accommodation, mobility and retention.